ns. W. le Gendre.

No 22.

2. Enclosures.

Handing over press copies of Correspondence relating to the wreck of the Bark "Rover".

U.S. Consulate General
Shanghai, China.
10 [illegible]

Received N° 22. ack Sep 13

DEPT. OF STATE
Recd AUG 27 '67

Consulate of the United States.

Amoy June 5th 1867

The Hon W. H. Seward.
Secretary of State.
Washington D.C.

Sir.

Handing over press copies of correspondence relating to the wreck of the Bark "Rover".

Referring to my Dispatches n° 17, 19 & 21, relating to the wreck of the American Bark "Rover". I have the honor to hand to you, under this Cover, Enclosures n° 1 & n° 2, being press copies of the English translations of a Dispatch just received from the General and Taotai of the Island of Formosa, & of my answer to it, both of which have been, this day, communicated to the U. S. Minister at Peking. (n° 1) (n° 2)

I have the honor to be.

Sir,

Your obedient Servant.

Chs. W. Le Gendre

U. S. Consul

Enclosure

Amoy – China.

With Dispatch No 22.

English translation of a dispatch from the Taotai & General of the Island of Formosa, relating to the wreck of the American Bark "Rover".

No 1

June 5th 1867.

anslation of a despatch received from the Taotai and General
f the island of Formosa relative to the wreck of the American
bark Rover

28th day, 3rd moon, Tung Chi 6th year.

The General and Taotai of Formosa, to the U.S. Consul at Amoy.

Beg to state to you, that on the 25th day 3rd moon this year, Mr Show the Magistrate of Fou Shan Hsing wrote to us the following,

"On the 18th day of this moon I have received the orders
"of your Excellencies, and the letter of the U.S. Consul Le-
"Gendre [here follow quotations of my dispatch being en-
"closure No 2 to my dispatch No 19 to the State office, being
"enclosure No 1 to my dispatch No 7 to your Excellency], as
"also the communication of Captain Febiger offering his
"co-operation.

"You appointed me to proceed with a military officer to the
"spot where the "Rover's" crew were murdered, directing me at
"the same time, to do all we should under the circumstances
"to keep friendship with the eastern nations, according to the
"treaties. Sometime since you communicated to me a dis-
"patch from Mr Carroll the British Consul, and gave me
"orders accordingly [here follows a resumé of Mr Carroll's
"letter]. On receipt of this dispatch we had already placed
ourselves in communication with Mr Carroll and the —

" Commissioner of Customs Mr White, to discuss various plans
" of action, and endeavoured to induce them to join in
" whatever we might do in the case. Both gentlemen repre-
" sented that the aborigines resemble wild animals, and like
" them are deprived of reasoning power, live in the forests,
" and hide themselves in the grass, in ambuscade against
" any civilized beings that may land on their coast. The
region inhabited by these tribes presents many obstacles
" to military operations

" We expressed the opinion to your Excellencies, that
" if the murderers are Chinese, they should receive a punish-
" ment that should be a warning for the future to all, and
" to the Americans a sufficient satisfaction for the past
" as the treaty prescribes. If on the contrary they belong
" to such tribes as do not recognize our authority, we
" should ascertain it, doing under the circumstances the
" best that we could to punish the guilty parties.

" Our first impulse when we received your order was,
" to proceed forthwith to the theatre of the tragedy; but
" our spies could not ascertain the length of the way by
" water and by land, they speak of numerous breakers in
" the Liu Kiau bay, and they say that with the contrary
winds [S.W. monsoon] the sea is dangerous in the ex-
" treme, and even with a steamer. Small fishing boats
" or trading craft are hardly manageable there. On

this wild coast covered with grass, and a natural refuge for wild animals and birds; indeed man has seldom appeared, and all consider it to be a very dangerous point.

Now we Tau Tuii [civil officer] Tai Tan and Loo Chan [military men] have detailed a subordinate [soldier] named Tan Chiin Whii, with men to whom the region is familiar, to build a good encampment for our forces, and to guide us on our way onward, with a view to ascertain whether the Rover's crew have been killed in that place known to us as being inhabited by tribes with whom our people are forbidden to hold communication of any kind, [in Chinese, where we do not even permit one of our Cows to penetrate]

He will find everything and be in readiness to act. He will also prepare a map which being forwarded to your Excellencies will enable you to decide upon a plan of operation.

At all events we shall prove that our Government entertains the kindest feelings for the eastern nation. When all this shall be done we will report to you again. We must let you know that our first column is ready, and that we are only awaiting your orders which we shall be proud to obey.

On receipt of the foregoing dispatch we have ordered our subordinate to do what he considered to be the best under the circumstances.

Signed Whow, &c &c —

Enclosure.

Amoy – China.

With Dispatch no 22.

English translation of an answer of the U.S. Consul to a Dispatch from the Taotai & General of the Island of Formosa, relating to the wreck of the American Bark "Rover".

No 2.

June 5th 1867.

[illegible] Amoy

May 3rd 1867

To the General and Taotai of Formosa

I have the honor to acknowledge the receipt of your dispatch of the 28th day, 3rd moon, Tung Chi 6th year.

In answer I would state, that I have spent two days at the Southern bay of the Island of Formosa, where the "Rover's" crew were murdered. There I saw small Chinese settlements, said to be in close and daily communication with the aborigines, reported to have murdered our Countrymen.

We came to anchor opposite the scene of the tragedy, without the least difficulty, but now that the S.W. monsoon is prevalent in this latitude, I doubt not that we would find the bay much less secure. Had you accepted the offer of Captain Febiger to convoy your forces, you could have operated a landing without the least difficulty. Having neglected to avail yourself of this opportunity, you will find no doubt the task much more arduous.

While at anchor, at the South bay, we saw a small junk at anchor, and we had a conversation with the crew composed of four men, named Coe Pang, Lei Ling, Nagh Poo, Gha Kwan, the last named commanding the junk. I do not believe that those men gave us very correct information, yet they acknowledged to be from Tai Wan Foo, and to be connected by trade with the Savages. We should have arrested them but as you requested us not to interfere in this affair, your desire being to settle it alone, we did not embarrass their movements, and allowed them to go free. Evidently those men belong to a class of Chinese that furnish shot and powder to the aborigines, who pay them in wood. Moreover, I believe that the murderers of our countrymen are not wild savages, as you state, for all the people we saw on the southern bay, have the appearance of Chinese, and like them, wear tails. We could soon have ascertained the fact, but having agreed not to embarrass your movements, we did not even attempt to land.

You should also know that I have been informed, that the only survivor of the "Rover's" Crew, having arrived at Lee Chew bay, on the 14th March, sent a message to the reported murderers of our countrymen, and the man having returned the same day, announced that five of the crew were killed on the 13th March. He also brought word that the other boat had arrived on the night of the 13th and that, next morning, two of the crew were killed. Another messenger sent to inquire of the other six men, reported that two more had been killed. So far you see we have intelligence of the murder of only 9 men, and I believe that the others including the Captain wife, are held in bondage by the inhabitants of the Southern bay.

I should also bring to your notice, that according to the last advices received by me from Foo Chau Fieng, no Chinese troops had been sent forward to the aborigin Country.

Under the circumstances, I should say that the sooner you punish the authors of the murder of our Countrymen, and you afford relief to such of those who may yet remain in bondage in their hands, the better you will carry the provisions of Articles XI & XIII of the treaty of Tientsin with the U.S.; and I take this opportunity to say again to you, that from the strict observance of the treaty on your part as well as on ours, will depend the continuation of the friendly relations, which I am happy to say, exist between our two Countries.

I am &c.

[Signed] Chs W Le Gendre
U.S. Consul.